# Medication Shortage Notice 21/11/2025
# Bupivacaine Epidural – change of product

## Supply issue

**Bupivacaine 0.125% 250ml epidural infusion bags** are currently unavailable. There is no known resupply date.

## Alternative product 1 (first line)

A product has been identified as a replacement:

**Bupivacaine 1.5mg/ml 0.15% 500ml bags**

**Note that this replacement product has a different concentration and comes in a different size to the original**

- Manufactured by *Fresenius Kabi*
- Unlicensed special
- Limited supply
- Storage instructions: store at 2-25°C

***Fresenius Kabi* – Bupivacaine 0.15% 500ml bags**

## Alternative product 2 (second line)

Replacement product if the above alternative is unavailable:

**Levobupivacaine 1.25mg/ml 0.125% 200ml bags**

- Manufactured by *Ethypharm (Martindale Pharma/Altan Pharma)*
- Licensed product
- Limited supply
- Storage instructions: No special storage conditions

## Administration and supply

- Use the unlicensed bupivacaine 0.15% first line
- Stock of bupivacaine 0.15% is restricted to a small supply each week
- Switch to using levobupivacaine 0.125% (200ml) bags when bupivacaine is out of stock

- Bupivacaine 0.15% and the levobupivacaine 0.125% can be prescribed and administered in the same way the 0.125% was used
- To prescribe on Epic search bupivacaine, epidural or levobupivacaine

Queries? Please discuss with your ward Pharmacist or email Medicines Info Team

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